

Graham Behavioral Medicine Lab

Stress, Walking and Timing (SWaT) Project

Research Assistant Onboarding & Training Plan

Welcome!

Welcome to the Graham Behavioral Medicine Lab's SWaT project. This plan is designed to help you build the background knowledge, research-ethics preparation, and study-specific skills you need before conducting sessions independently. Please complete the steps in order.

Part I. Pre-Training Onboarding

Step 1. Confidentiality and Project Introduction

Complete within three days of receiving this document.

- Sign the Confidentiality Agreement. [Download the confidentiality form](#). Enter your name in the first paragraph and sign on the second page.
 - Send the completed agreement to Samantha on Slack.
- Read the Introduction to the SWaT Project. [Project overview and study approach](#).
 - This overview will help you become familiar with the project before the hands-on training sessions.

Step 2. Research Ethics, Methods, and Field Background

Complete the remaining onboarding items by May 22, 2026.

- Complete CSU-required CITI research training. [CITI Training](#) (approximately 1-2 hours; you may complete it across multiple sittings).
 - After completion, send your CITI certificate to Samantha on Slack.
- Review introductory research-methods materials:
 - [Basic Concepts of an Experiment in Psychology \(10:47\)](#)
 - [Measurement Lecture \(18:59\)](#)
- Build background in behavioral medicine and sedentary behavior:
 - [What Is Behavioral Medicine?](#) - focus on the three green boxes.
 - [Stand Up for Your Health: Breaking Sedentary Habits](#)

Part II. Study-Specific Training

SRA = Senior Research Assistant; NRA = New Research Assistant. Before each training session, review the corresponding study protocol.

Step 3. Study Procedure and Recording Orientation

- [Study Procedure Overview Video](#)
- [Introduction to the Trier Social Stress Test \(TSST\)](#)
- Review example TSST recordings:
 - [Example TSST Recording 1](#)
 - [Example TSST Recording 2](#)
- [Introduction to Interview Procedures](#)
- Review example interview recordings:
 - [Example Interview Recording 1](#)
 - [Example Interview Recording 2](#)
 - [Example Interview Recording 3](#)

Step 4. Lab Orientation

- [Lab Orientation / General Study Protocol](#)

Session 1 - Lab familiarization (30 minutes, in person)

- One SRA may train up to four NRAs.
- Get to know the training group.
- Become familiar with the lab space, equipment locations, room access, and general workflow.

Step 5. Interview Training

- [Interview Protocol](#)

Practice Sessions 1-3 - Interview practice (1 hour each; virtual or in person)

- One SRA works with one NRA; use different pairings across sessions when possible.
- Work through every interview question and practice appropriate probing across different participant responses.
- The SRA records areas for improvement, shares feedback with the NRA, and sends a brief training report to Skylar.

Quality Check - Interview competency check (1 hour; virtual)

- Skylar works one-on-one with the NRA.

Step 6. TSST Training

Applies to female RAs assigned to TSST evaluator roles.

- [TSST Evaluator Protocol](#)

Practice Sessions 1-3 - TSST evaluator practice (45 minutes each; virtual or in person)

- One SRA works with two NRAs; use different pairings across sessions when possible.

- The two NRAs alternate between Evaluator A and Evaluator B roles.
- The SRA records areas for improvement, shares feedback with each NRA, and sends a brief training report to Skylar.

Quality Check - TSST competency check (30 minutes; virtual)

- Skylar works one-on-one with the NRA.

Step 7. Lab Visit 1 Protocol Training

- [Lab Visit 1 Protocol](#)

Session 1 - Guided walkthrough (1.5 hours; in person)

- One SRA works with one to two NRAs.
- Walk through every protocol step and task.

Session 2 - Supported independent practice (1.5 hours; in person)

- One SRA works with one NRA.
- The NRA completes each step independently while the SRA answers questions and helps troubleshoot.
- The SRA records areas for improvement, shares feedback with the NRA, and sends a brief training report to Skylar.

Session 3 - Speed run-through (1.5 hours; in person)

- One SRA works with one NRA.
- The SRA acts as the participant; spend approximately two minutes on each task.
- The SRA records areas for improvement, shares feedback with the NRA, and sends a brief training report to Skylar.

Session 4 - Full quality-check run-through (2 hours; in person)

- Skylar works with the NRA.
- Complete the full Lab Visit 1 protocol.

Step 8. Lab Visit 2 Protocol Training

- [Lab Visit 2 Protocol - Before](#)
- [Lab Visit 2 Protocol - During](#)
- [Lab Visit 2 Protocol - After](#)
- [Lab Visit 2 Protocol - Control](#)

Session 1 - Guided walkthrough (1.5 hours; in person)

- One SRA works with one to two NRAs.
- Walk through every protocol step and task.

Session 2 - Supported independent practice (1.5 hours; in person)

- One SRA works with one NRA.
- The NRA completes each step independently while the SRA answers questions and helps troubleshoot.

- The SRA records areas for improvement, shares feedback with the NRA, and sends a brief training report to Skylar.

Session 3 - Speed run-through (2 hours; in person)

- One SRA works with one NRA.
- The SRA acts as the participant; spend approximately five minutes on each phase.
- The SRA records areas for improvement, shares feedback with the NRA, and sends a brief training report to Skylar.

Session 4 - Full quality-check run-through (3 hours; in person)

- Skylar works with the NRA.
- Complete the full Lab Visit 2 protocol.